Direct - Kaitlyn said, "I am very busy now."

Indirect - Kaitlyn said that she was very busy then.

- Two verbs commonly used while reporting are 'told' and 'said.'

  He said (that) he was cooking dinner.

  He told me (that) he was cooking dinner.

- Did you notice that 'tell'/'told' has been used in the sentence which mentions the listener?
- In reported speech we need not mention the listener when we use 'say'/ 'said.'

  He said (that) he was cooking. (listener not mentioned)

  In direct speech we say: Rahim said to me, 'I will be waiting here.'

- In Direct Speech, we use inverted commas to mark off the exact words of the speaker. In Indirect Speech we do not.

Rules for changing Direct Speech into Indirect.

Original tense	Reported tense	Example
Simple Present	Simple Past	"I am happy" - He said (that) he was happy.
Present Continuous	Past Continuous	"He saw it" – She said he had seen it
Present Perfect	Past Perfect	"She's gone" – You said she had gone
Simple Past	Past Perfect	"I left" – You said you had left
Past Continuous	Past Perfect Continuous	"He was reading" – He said he had been reading
can	could	"I can sing" – She said she could sing
may	might	"We may stay" – They said they might stay
must	had to	"I must go" – He said he had to go
will	would	"I'll buy them" – You said you would buy them

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